

Jintong Yang

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Education

University of California, Santa Barbara

PhD in Media Arts and Technology

2025–Present

Santa Barbara, CA

- GPA: 3.95/4.0 | Coursework: *Designing Expressive Technologies, Human-Computer Interaction, Media Signal Processing.*

School of Visual Arts

MFA in Computer Arts

2020–2023

New York, NY

- GPA: 4.0/4.0 | Coursework: *Motion Graphics, Creative Programming for Artists, Non-linear Storytelling.*
- Awards: SVA Paula Rhodes Memorial Award 2023, MFA Computer Arts Awards & 2023 Thesis Finishing Grant.

Beijing International Studies University

BA in Trade Economics (International Cultural Trade) & BA in English

2016–2020

Beijing, China

- GPA: 3.79/4.0 | Coursework: *Calculus, Linear Algebra, Statistics, Econometrics, International Trade, Cultural Marketing.*
- Awards: BISU 2020 Outstanding Graduate & Merit Student Award (2017, 2018, 2019).

Research Interests

HCI, Creative Support Tools, Motion Graphics & Animation, Live Performance, Tangible & Multimodal Interaction, AR/VR

Research Experience

Student Researcher

ReTouch Lab (PI: Yon Visell), UC Santa Barbara

Apr 2026–Present

Santa Barbara, CA

- Exploring how dynamic visual-haptic media generated by a fingertip tactile pixel array (TPP) device can support content creation in VR experience, game design, or live performance.
- Prototyping Unity environments for visual-haptic interaction with digital textures, exploring streaming protocols and authoring abstractions that bridge hardware control with user-facing creative tools.
- Conducting literature review on cross-modal perception, LLM-driven texture authoring, and haptic content generation.

Research Assistant

National Institute of Cultural Development (Mentor: Jiashan Li)

Oct 2016–Jun 2018

Beijing, China

- Analyzed international cultural trade and service trends, contributing to research on the preservation and promotion of Chinese cultural heritage such as Peking Opera through emerging media forms.
- Proofread and organized research documents and compiled monthly newsletters highlighting relevant activities and events.
- Assisted in preparing materials for lectures and conferences, including cooperation talks with the Serbian Embassy and the China–Central and Eastern European Countries Cultural and Creative Industry Forum.
- Assisted in writing and editing cultural trade publications, including the New York City chapter of *Research on Beijing International Sister Cities - Cultural Market Volume* (Li, J., 2019).

Work Experience

UCSB Graduate Student Association (GSA) - Social Media Coordinator

University of California, Santa Barbara

Feb 2026–Present

Santa Barbara, CA

- Manage GSA's social media and official website, including poster design, interview, video production, and visual newsletters.
- Grew follower count and student engagement with campus events through clearer, more compelling visual communication.

Technical Artist / Associate Artist

SOLID PIXELS

Nov 2023–Feb 2025

New York, NY

- Researched and prototyped generative AI techniques (e.g., StyleGAN) for live performance, and developed interactive UIs and video content deployed in exhibitions and events across China and the U.S.
- Worked on visual and interaction design for “Dear Lord, Make Me Beautiful” at Park Avenue Armory (Dec 2024), New York.
- Streamlined digital asset pipelines by refining 3D-scanned models and establishing archiving workflows.

Freelance Digital Designer

Jun 2023–Feb 2025

- Designed and produced films, animation, and motion graphics content for commercial, live events, and independent projects, working with clients such as Sotheby's, Columbia University, Iron, Wood & Glitter Productions, and Ascension 180 LLC.

Lab Assistant

Jan–Dec 2022

MFA Computer Arts Lab, School of Visual Arts

New York, NY

- Posted departmental announcements and event information, and conducted data collection and analysis on graduate outcomes to assess program impact and improve communication between students and faculty.
- Managed and maintained audiovisual equipment and assisted with departmental exhibitions, handling technical setup, logistics coordination, and on-site support for media productions.

Media Intern

May–Aug 2019

China Television Drama Production Industry Association

Beijing, China

- Assisted in event preparation, organized interviews, and drafted written materials, including copywriting for television drama events. Designed promotional videos, posters, marketing materials, and visual themes for events.

Film Marketing Development Volunteer

Apr 2019

Beijing International Film Festival

Beijing, China

- Participated in organizing, coordinating, and facilitating venture capital events, copyright trading, award ceremonies, and project negotiations for film projects in the Beijing market.

Teaching Experience

Academic Writing & Graduate Application Mentor

May 2025–Present

- Mentored students applying to PhD and Master's programs, providing end-to-end guidance on research proposal development, academic writing, and application strategy. Two students admitted to programs in Creative Media and Urban Design.
- Provided iterative, in-depth feedback on written materials, focusing on structure, argumentation, and clarity; guided literature review and research framing HCI and interdisciplinary media fields.

K-12 Distance Support Teaching

Nov 2018–May 2020

Beijing International Studies University

Beijing, China

- Conducted weekly online classes for K-12 students in rural Gansu Province, China, integrating fundamental knowledge with hands-on activities rooted in local traditions. Taught over 50 children, accumulating a total of 98 teaching hours.

Skills

Programming: Python, JavaScript, C++, HTML/CSS

Expertise: Animation & Motion Graphics, VR/AR Development, UI/UX Design, 3D Modeling & Design, Digital Fabrication, Interaction Design, Generative AI

Tools: Blender, Cinema 4D, TouchDesigner, Unreal Engine, Unity, Arduino, p5.js, Figma, Adobe Creative Suite (After Effects, Premiere Pro, Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Audition), Max/MSP/Jitter, Canva

AI / ML: PyTorch, Stable Diffusion, ComfyUI, ControlNet, LoRA, StyleGAN, OpenAI API, Midjourney

Research Skills: *Qualitative* (Participatory Design, Ethnography, Phenomenology, Thematic Analysis, Heuristic Evaluation); *Quantitative* (Survey Design, Experimental Design, Usability Testing); *Mixed Methods* (Case Study, Prototyping, Storyboarding)

Achievements

Jun 2026 | Certificate in Inclusive Teaching (CIT), UCSB

Dec 2025 | Pillars of Teaching Assistantship Certificate, UCSB

Jul 2024 | Shortlisted, The Meta Morph AI Film Award 2024, New York, NY

Jan 2024 | 2nd Place Prize in "Performance", NYC IO Film Festival

Jan 2024 | Selected Artist, 7th NYNG "BEST INSTALLATION", New York Nil Gallery

Sep 2023 | Shortlisted, Global Design Graduate Show 2023 in collaboration with Gucci

Sep 2023 | Selected Artist, *LAYERS OF REALITY*, Romanian Cultural Institute, New York, NY

Jun 2023 | Selected Artist, *change of he(art)*, SVA Chelsea Gallery, New York, NY

Dec 2022 | Selected Artist, *Lonely ROCKS*, Art Basel Miami Beach 2022, Miami, FL

Jul 2020 | Outstanding Graduate, Beijing Regular Institutions of Higher Education

Feb 2018 | Outstanding Works Award, Design, ArtOne Awards: The 1st International Design Competition

Apr 2017 | 3rd Prize, Computer Design Competition of Chinese College Students